

JANASIKSHA PROCHAR KENDRA

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HOW, WHERE, AND FOR WHAT THE ORGANIZATION IS WORKING

MISSION OF THE ORGANIZATION

Janasiksha Prochar Kendra (JPK) was conceived and incepted to extend developmental service to the people in difficult circumstances with focus on women and children.

REGISTRATION

The Organization is registered under the West Bengal Societies Registration Act No. XXVI (1961)

Registration No.S/12026 dt.09.08.72

FCRA No. 147120188 dt. 19.04.85 issued by the Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India

THE ORGANIZATION

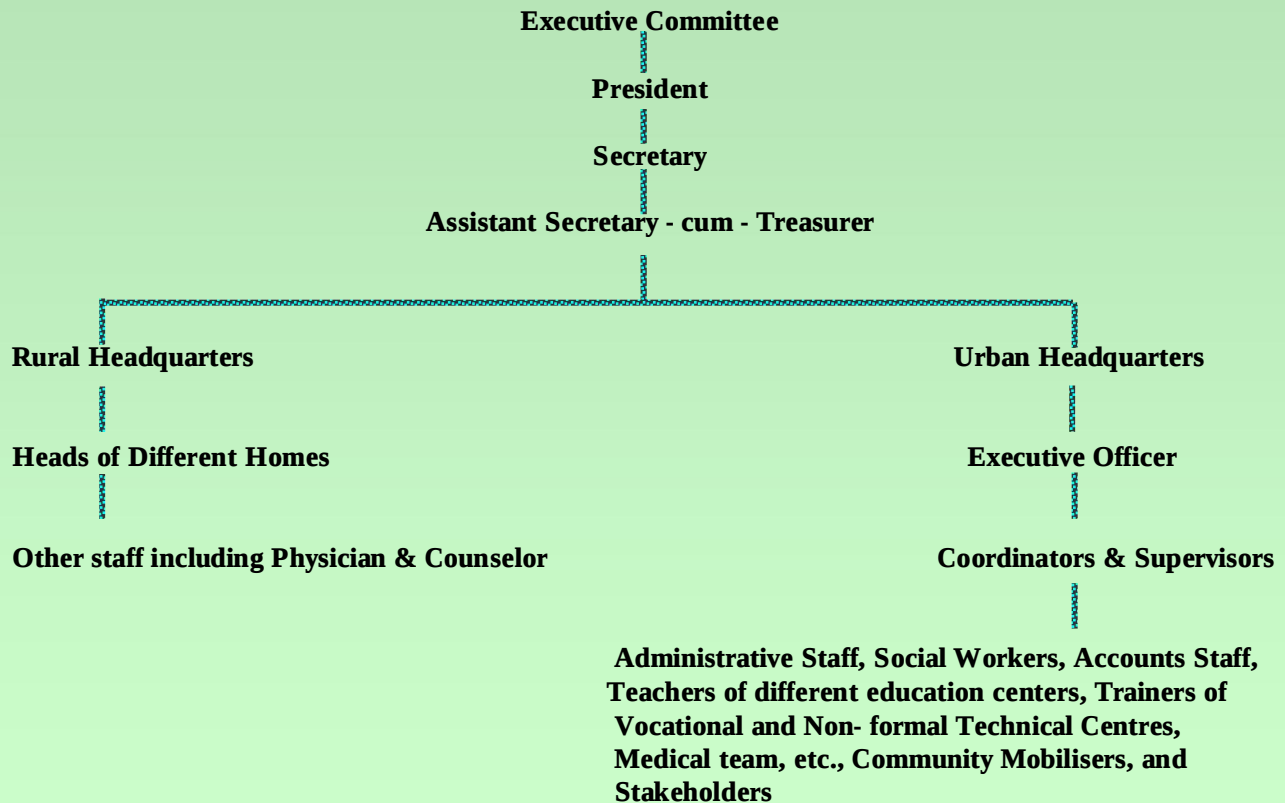
Janasiksha Prochar Kendra started its journey four decades ago with the avowed objective of eradication of illiteracy from amongst the rural poor in addition to rendering other developmental services to the under-privileged sections of the society with focus on women and children in difficulty. During these years, with support from Central and State Government, Welfare Boards, and International Donor Agencies, the organization has expanded its activities manifold, supplementing governmental activities in social welfare both in rural and urban areas, including red light areas.



MANAGEMENT

At the head of the organization there is an Executive Committee headed by the President, the members of which are elected every year in an annual general meeting. The committee sits every three months or earlier --- depending on exigency---within the ambit of rules and by-laws of the organization. The day-to-day administration is looked after by the Secretary, ably assisted by a team of dedicated and experienced workers, and sub-committees for each project under the superintendence, direction, and control of the Executive Committee. Fund management is also very transparent, each project having a separate bank account being operated under dual signatory system. Commercial double entry system is maintained and the accounts of each project and that of the organization as a whole are audited every year by a renowned audit firm of the city.

STRUCTURE OF THE MANAGEMENT



We have a team of 151 experienced and well-trained paid staff and 21 volunteers.

AREAS OF WORK

- (i) Education – both non-formal and formal
- (ii) Skill upgradation – vocational and non-formal technical training
- (iii) Development of child labour
- (iv) Supplementary nutrition
- (v) Health care
- (vi) Cultural development
- (vii) Shelter Homes for destitute elderly persons, women, and girls in difficult circumstances for empowerment and rehabilitation
- (viii) Cross-cutting Issues – HIV/AIDS, child marriage, dowry menace, population stabilization, drug addiction and alcoholism, trafficking, etc.

AWARDS AND ACCOLADES

In recognition of its missionary service, the organization has won the following prestigious awards.

Year	Recognition
1994	Received National Award for Excellence in working in the city's Red Light Area from the President of India at Rashtrapati Bhavan
1998	Received State Level Award from Nehru Children Museum from the Governor of West Bengal at G.D. Birla Sabhaghar, Ballygunge for implementing Adult Education Centre for eradication of illiteracy from amongst the rural poor and publication of books and other educational materials.
2002	Received a State Level Award from the Governor of West Bengal at Raj Bhavan, Kolkata, for Excellence of work in Rural Development

FORWARD LOOKING

Planning for years ahead is done basically on the suggestions emanating in the Annual General Meeting -a forum for the members of the organization – and suggestions relating to the working of welfare activities derived from the meeting of the Project heads. Reformative action where required are recorded for action. Our emphasis has always been on up gradation, and confidence building amongst the beneficiaries and project managers so as to bring about an atmosphere of congeniality, i.e., an ideal working model.

We are not a static organization but strongly believe in expansion. Our social workers are accordingly under direction to reach yet uncovered areas of the project area to identify the deprived and depraved and to provide solace and support in their otherwise dry and dreadful existence.

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CURRENT ACTIVITIES

IN RURAL AREAS

OLD AGE HOME

Due to rapid social changes in our society, nuclear families of today are increasingly becoming reluctant in taking care of the elderly members of the family. For care and nursing which these people need most at the fag end of life, we have been running the Old Age Home since 1998 to provide shelter to 25 elderly persons --- male and female. The Project is financed by the Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment, Government of India. During the year under review, two elderly persons expired and their last rites were performed by the organization. With new admissions, the number of inmates as on 31st March 2012 is 19. Our efforts are to keep them happy and content.



SHORT STAY HOME



The Home was set up in December 1991 with grant-in-aid from the Central Social Welfare Board for the deserted and socially estranged women / girls of the age group 15 – 35 for re-integration into the family or rehabilitation in a meaningful way through education, skill upgradation and counseling. The capacity of the Home is 30. Follow-up action is taken to see that their rehabilitation is stable. The number of inmates as on 31.03.2012 is 26. 246 girls and women have been rehabilitated so far. Last year 12 inhabitants were successfully reintegrated into the family.

SWADHAR HOME

Mainly due to population explosion, a sizable section of our society still lives below poverty despite economic growth at reasonable rate after Independence. On account of reasons ranging from economic instability of the family, breakdown of joint family system and to social bias, many a time our families fail to extend emotional and physical support to the extended members of the family, especially for women in difficult circumstances like widows, poor and deserted women, women ex-prisoners, victims of sexual abuse and crime including those trafficked and rescued from brothels, women rendered homeless due to natural calamity, etc. These marginalized women are compelled to lead a life of sub-human existence ending up as beggars or prostitutes for their own survival and sometimes for their dependent children also.



To mitigate the suffering of these unfortunate women, the NGO has established Swadhar Home, funded by the Ministry of Women and Child Development, Government of India in 2005 – 2006. The capacity of the Home is 50 with 45 women living as on 31.03.2012. Till date 32 women have been rehabilitated. For the inmates of this Home they being women in most difficult circumstances, and having no trace of family connection, rehabilitation is rather difficult.

The scheme has gone a long way to rehabilitate women in difficult circumstances --- socially and economically --- through normal channels of development like counseling, skill up gradation, need-based education, personality development through behavioral training. They are regaining here what they have lost elsewhere and will have a fresh lease of life.

CRECHE

With funding support from the West Bengal Social Welfare Advisory Board, JPK has been running two (2) crèches at Ganesbati and Prasadpur Bhumijpara in Jangipara Block in Hooghly District, sheltering 25 kids each under the care of two (2) Mothers and two (2) Assistants. Throughout the year they are provided with nutritious food and health care, including first lessons in habit formation and pre-school education through models, charts and pictures narrated in rhymes in vernacular with matching facilities of playing with toys, etc. The demand from the BPL and poor families being always high, the creches remain full to capacity all the year round.



HOME UNDER J.J. ACT : (For girl with red light antecedent)



Under the Government of West Bengal, Department of Social Welfare Notification No. 2118/1(200) SW dt. 22.05.1998, we established a Home accommodating 25 girls with red light antecedents for protection, care and rehabilitation through normal channels of development like education, counselling, health care, skill upgradation, games and recreation. Out of 22 girls residing as on 31.03.2012, all were admitted in government-aided schools and it is expected that in course of time they will be mainstreamed to enjoy a peaceful family life with dignity.

We have already applied for enhancement of the inmates from 25 to 50, which has been recommended by the District Magistrate, Hooghly to the Director of Social Welfare, Government of West Bengal. It is expected that the sanction of the competent authority will soon be received.

DESTITUTE HOME (COTTAGE)

The Government of West Bengal has since sanctioned a Destitute Home (Cottage) sheltering 25 girls. At present 6 inmates out of 11 recommended by the Government are staying in the cottage for care, protection, and empowerment through natural course of development like school education, coaching, counselling, health care, and cultural development.

HEALTH SERVICE

To maintain regular health check-up, two qualified medical practitioners --- one male and one female --- are visiting once a week. In critical cases, patients are taken to government hospitals for proper treatment. People from poor community are also allowed free-of-cost health check-up by Home physicians.



VOCATIONAL TRAINING-CUM-PRODUCTION CENTRE



In the rural complex, we arrange vocational training in tailoring, knitting, chumki knitting, saree cutting, button making, handicraft, etc., for the inhabitants with aptitude and eagerness to enable hapless women to stand on their feet in future.

GAMES AND SPORTS/RECREATION

Every care is taken to see that the girls take part in outdoor games in the open field and in children's park attached to the complex. They enjoy the park and the games very much. They also delight themselves with indoor games and T.V. watching. Like previous years, annual sports were held in winter season with prizes distributed amongst the winners and food packets to all.



PROTECTION OF WOMEN AGAINST DOMESTIC VIOLENCE ACT, 2005

Under the above Act, JPK was registered as a service provider w.e.f. 18.08.2008 by the competent Authority. Two (2) of our employees have been working as service providers, protecting women from torture meted out by family members, adopting various means, including counseling and taking help of stakeholders and Panchayat/Municipal members. During the year under report, 11 women were protected and follow-up action was also taken to see that the measures adopted are productive.

LIBRARY

The library of our rural infrastructure has a stock of about 1600 books. The boarders have the facility of reading books, magazines, newspapers, and periodicals in the Central Hall attached to the library.

IN URBAN AREAS

INTEGRATED PROGRAMME OF STREET CHILDREN/DAY CARE CENTRE

In place of Integrated Programme of Street Children (IPSC), we have been running Day Care centres on the lines of the Street Children Programme. More or less 400 children are attending Day Care centres as on 31.03.2012. The Centres provide education, health care, tiffin, recreation, and cultural development.



OPEN SHELTER

With effect from 1st April 2011, we have been running an Open Shelter under ICPS at CK – 6, Sector II, Salt Lake City, Kolkata sheltering 25 girls in vulnerable life situation. We provide them all promotional incentives like school education, coaching support, counseling, health care, games and sports, and cultural development with a view to mainstream them in future. 21 children were admitted in formal school during the year.

COACHING CENTRE



Children admitted into formal schools after completion of their pre-primary education in red light areas are provided with coaching support at centres at Dadabhai Sangha (Bowbazar), Narikalyan, Darjipara (Sonagachi), Seth Bagan, and Kalyan Parishad (all in red light areas) to ensure continuity in school. More than 200 children are being coached in four (4) coaching centres under the guidance of 6 teachers. To improve their social consciousness, children of Day Care Centres and those of coaching centres are encouraged to participate in groups in various programmes like Independence Day, Republic Day, Tagore's Birthday, and Saraswati Puja. They also take part in competitions in the sphere of sports and cultural activities.

ICDS (INTEGRATED CHILD DEVELOPMENT SCHEME) IN RED LIGHT AREAS

About 900 kids of red light area in the age group of 3 to 5⁺ have been admitted in all 28 Anganwadi centres opened at Seth Bagan, Sonagachi, Rambagan, Jorabagan, and Bowbazar (all red light areas) with grant-in-aid from the West Bengal Government. In these centres, special emphasis is given on cleanliness, habit formation, and information about nature and environment. Besides, they are provided with 6 services, viz., pre-education, nutrition, immunization, health care, health check-up, and referral service. Each centre is managed by one AWW, assisted by an AW Helper. In the last financial year, about 200 children were admitted into these centres. Supplementary nutrition is arranged for them along with expectant mothers. Immunization programmes including pulse polio are attended. Efforts are being made to open more centres in red light areas. 151 children were formalized during the year.



SIKSHALAYA PROKALPA

Under the orders of Sarva Siksha Mission, Kolkata, the NGO has reduced its centres from 14 to 7 Shikshalaya Prokalpa Schools of primary standard in different wards of Kolkata w.e.f 01.04.2010 accommodating only 350 out of school and drop-out children. The project is financed by Sarba Siksha Mission, Kolkata. 61 children were admitted in class V of formal schools during the year.



COMMUNITY HEALTH CENTRE

About 50 patients are being treated every week in four community health centres located at Chetla, Majherhat, Duttabad and Brace Bridge under the care of three (3) qualified part time doctors catering to the needs of community in general and children of our centres in particular. The cost of the project is shared by different programmes.

AWARENESS PROGRAMME



From time to time, the NGO organizes awareness generation programmes both in rural and urban areas amongst the community people on various burning problems of the society. During the year such programmes on HIV/AIDS, stabilization of population, child marriage, trafficking, alcoholism and drug addiction, dowry system, rights of women and their empowerment, sex discrimination, elimination of child labour, etc., were organized and which created a tangible impact on the general people.

VOCATIONAL TRAINING AND PRODUCTION CENTRE

About 130 adolescent girls mainly of red light areas received training in vocational trades like embroidery, tailoring, knitting, batik, bandhni, beautician, etc., in seven (7) centres during the year under review. This training will help them to stand on their feet in course of time.



NIGHT SHELTER

During the working hours of their mothers, the children of poor sex workers generally loiter on the streets aimlessly, exposing themselves not only to the rigours of nature --- rain and cold --- but also to the cunning and greed of the brothel keepers. To save these uncared children from this vulnerable position, two (2) Night Shelters are being operated in red light areas in Sonagachi and Prem Chand Baral Street to accommodate about 65 children in the age group of 7- 8 years. The centres remain open from 7 p.m. to 10 p.m. to provide the children with pre-primary education, supplementary nutrition, habit formation, recreation, etc., for proper upbringing.



INTERNAL GENERATION OF FUND

No NGO despite its size can afford to remain indifferent to fund raising from indigenous source. Since the project-based grants are mostly time bound, project organisers face difficulties when the grants are stopped, with Project goals remaining unfulfilled. We have learnt from practical experience the importance of constantly sourcing and generating new avenues of fund with our own efforts to keep us working with head up.

We are glad that years of working has enabled us to create such a fund coming from the rental from our urban property, sale of educational materials and books published by us for the need of the students of Sarva Siksha Mission, and sale of agriculture products. On an average, the amount of self generated fund is Rupees 12 Lakh to 12.50 Lakh per year. This has emboldened us to say that the organization would not “die of starvation.”

PLANNING AHEAD

From the experience we gained during the last forty years working amongst the marginalized sections of the society, we learnt that these people need mainly three things for empowerment --- education, livelihood development, and a decent family life. Of these three, livelihood development occupies prime consideration in as much as empowerment of this part enables a man to earn meaningfully to support himself and his family ensuring also the normal development of the future generation.

So, the NGO contemplates to undertake a project assisting the vulnerable sections of the society, both in urban and rural area, in whatever livelihood initiative they are engaged --- agriculture, artisan, small trade, hawking, small transport, poultry keeping, animal husbandry and the like in the way of awareness education, skill up gradation training, arrangement of seed money. Once they become self reliant in their respective livelihood initiative, they will be able to take care of everything in a better way including education and empowerment of the children. Perpetual poverty, a curse having no parallel, will be a thing of the past from the lives of these vulnerable people.

